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New York University's Leif D. Nelson and Tom Meyvis explored a surprising phenomenon in a 2008 study.

The researchers recruited participants who were told they would be reviewing a massage cushion.

Participants were split into two groups.

The first group used the device for three minutes (180 seconds) without a break.

The second group used the massage cushion for two periods of 80 seconds, with a 20-second break between sessions.

Afterwards, participants were asked to rate their enjoyment of the massage on a nine-point scale (one = not pleasant; nine = extremely pleasant).

Those who had a three-minute massage gave an average rating of 6.05 out of 9.

However, those forced to take a 20-second break during their massage gave a rating of 7.05 — that's a 17% improvement in satisfaction.

At first glance, that's counter-intuitive.

The group who had the shorter massage enjoyed it more.

But the theory is that the break in pleasure prevents us from becoming too familiar with the positive experience and thus noticing it less — a process called habituation.